



The Garamut
"The message sender"

Ps Barry Reflections from 'The WORD'!

**For PRAYER,
 PROCLAMATION &
 PERSONAL PROGRESS**

Bethel Global Missions

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PRAYER

MY AIM: FOR US TO REFLECT, PONDER, CONTEMPLATE.

- ★ In this reflection can I ask you all to read **slowly** (taking time to ponder) over every statement written about prayer **even if it seems to be repetition.**
- ★ It is purposefully written this way to impact and cause us to renew our thinking of the value of prayer in our daily lives.

WHAT IS PRAYER?

Because there have been many presentations on the place and value of prayer in the life of every Christ believer and the different kinds of prayer that they are commanded to pray relative to their circumstances which are very relevant and important.

However, I would like to present the two pressing questions that are very relevant to those who on a regular basis are interacting and dealing with people who are from all different ethnic backgrounds, faiths, and philosophical persuasions.

Those two questions are:

1. **WHY DO PEOPLE PRAY?** (Referring to all peoples (i.e. Mankind).
 2. **WHAT IS PRAYER?** (for the Christian).
- ★ **WHY DO PEOPLE PRAY?** - Referring to all people in general (Mankind).

★ **PEOPLE PRAY BECAUSE OF AN INHERENT DESIRE.**

ALL HUMAN BEINGS POSSESS AN INHERENT, INBORN NATURAL DESIRE to seek the "Divine" (beyond this earth).

- *That all human beings possess an **inherent, natural, or inborn desire to seek the divine, often described as a "restlessness" of the heart or a "hunger" of the intellect.***
- **This concept of an "inherent desire in all men** for the divine" (or a divine inheritance) is a recurring theme in theological, philosophical, and spiritual literature, often emphasizing a **universal, innate longing for connection** with God or a higher power.
- **PRAYER is an INSTINCTIVE (IN BORN) LONGING and deep INNER IMPULSE or URGE** to connect with a power greater than oneself.
- **This inner desire** is often framed as a "divine inheritance" or a "spiritual DNA" that defines human purpose.
- **IT IS THE COMMUNICATION OF THE HUMAN SOUL WITH THE DIVINE (GOD).**
- For some people **PRAYER is the heart's urgent cry for** a constant conversation with the Creator, acting as a lifeline that connects, transforms and aligns oneself with divine power.

★ **THE ESSENCE OF PRAYER - FOR THE CHRISTIAN BELIEVER.**

PRAYER AS COMMUNION WITH GOD IS RELATIONSHIP RATHER THAN MERE RITUAL.

- **IT'S ABOUT THE HEART, NOT THE HABIT.**
- **IT'S RELATIONSHIP OVER REQUEST.**
- **IT IS DOING LIFE WITH GOD.**
- **Prayer** is viewed as a "surge of the heart" or a "simple look turned toward heaven".

★ PRAYER IS NOT MEDITATION OR PASSIVE REFLECTION. IT IS A DIRECT ADDRESS TO GOD.

- Prayer is the **PRIMARY** way to Communicate.
- Prayer is defined as an "INTIMATE FRIENDSHIP" OR CONVERSATION with God. It emphasizes personal relationship.
- IT IS TALKING TO GOD audibly, silently, in private, or in public.
- ★ PRAYER IS NOT **ELOQUENCE**, BUT **EARNESTNESS**.
- It is the **language of a heart burdened** with a sense of need".
- It is a **longing of the soul** to express itself.
- IT IS **RELATIONAL COMMUNICATION** where we communicate our emotions, desires and gratitude to God.

★ PRAYER IS MORE THAN A MERE RITUAL OR REQUEST LIST.

- PRAYER SHOULD SERVE AS A **SPIRITUAL DIALOGUE**, A HEARTFELT, SPONTANEOUS, AND **SOMETIMES SILENT SHARING** OF ONE'S INNER BEING TO FIND PEACE, GUIDANCE, AND ALIGNMENT WITH DIVINE WILL.
- PRAYER IS A WAY TO DEVELOP A GENUINE **FRIENDSHIP** WITH GOD, FOCUSING ON **FELLOWSHIP** RATHER THAN SOLELY **ASKING** FOR FAVOURS.
- ★ IT SERVES AS an **ASPIRATION** OF THE HEART, highlighting the aspect of a longing desire within the person.
- ★ IT IS an **IMPULSE OF THE SOUL**, emphasizing spontaneous and unprompted nature free from external energy or human intervention.
- ★ IT SERVES AS an **EXCHANGE OF DIVINE ENERGY** - A "THERMOMETER OF THE SOUL" that measures a person's real spiritual condition.
- ★ PRAYER SERVES AS A BRIDGE BETWEEN THE HUMAN EXPERIENCE AND THE DIVINE, (GOD).
- ★ Prayer is offered in **FAITH** in the name of **Jesus Christ**, and through the **Holy Spirit**.

★ DEVELOPING A GENUINE FRIENDSHIP WITH GOD.

PRAYER IS:

A way to develop a genuine friendship with God, focusing on **fellowship** rather than solely asking for favours.

PRAYER IS:

The passionate, heartfelt, and essential breath of the soul, serving as a direct, living connection between humanity and God. It transcends mere words, acting as a deep longing or "desire for God" that nourishes spiritual life, provides inner peace, and brings freedom.

PRAYER IS:

A "surge of the heart with a simple **LOOK towards heaven**".

FOR THE CHRIST BELIEVER (internet).

- Prayer is a powerful transformative tool that **shifts circumstances**, **changes** hearts, and **aligns** human requests with divine purpose.
 - It serves as a means for believers to **actively influence events**, offering comfort in crises, providing access to the supernatural, giving assurance that God listens and responds to the needs of His people.
1. Prayer **changes** circumstances situations, obstacles, and outcomes that would not have occurred otherwise.
 2. Prayer **aligns** us with God's promises and brings about divine intervention.
 3. Prayer **transforms** hearts and attitudes of people, affecting positive change.
 4. Prayer **connects** with God and allows us to address our concerns etc.
 5. Prayer **brings** about spiritual growth and supplies material needs.
 6. Prayer **stimulates** and grows faith and trust in the person.
 7. Prayer **joins** us with the miraculous resulting in divine healing, deliverance, and creative miracles.
 8. Prayer **affects** inward change in the believer creating Godly desire and alignment with God's will and his work on earth.
 9. Prayer **keeps** us hungry and thirsty for God and humble and pliable before him.

★ SO LET US PRAY AND KEEP ON PRAYING - **AFFIRMING** THAT OUR GOD IS ABLE!
Amen.